

scanner doesn't seem to look for spyware, and you can only detect spyware when performing a system scan.

On the downside, Norton Antivirus is still quite system heavy, which may put off a lot of performance enthusiasts. Don't expect to do much on your computer while running a system scan as that will easily drain most of your resources, making every other application painfully slow. Nonetheless, Symantec's reputation with virus definitions, the extensive protection against all kinds of malicious software and the best interface among all antivirus packages, makes Norton a strong option.

Pros: Excellent interface; great virus definition support

Cons: Significantly system heavy; no real-time spyware detection.

McAfee VirusScan Home 9.0

McAfee antivirus packages have always been a great option, but if there was one particular flaw that made some users shy away from it, it was the complicated interface. But version 9.0's tabular interface makes sure that all the required options are well sorted and easy-to-find.

McAfee is generally light on the system as it secretly keeps a watch on all the files accessed by your system. Just like Norton Antivirus 2005, it can detect viruses, trojans and worms in real-time, but detects spyware and adware only during the system scan. The good thing is running a system scan on regular intervals is not really a big issue, because even though the system scanning process

